

BUSN 5000 Project Guide

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Table of contents

Preface	1
How to use this guide	1
Acknowledgments	1
1 Setup	3
1.1 Outline (to be written)	3
2 Pre-project	5
2.1 Outline (to be written)	5
3 Main Project	7
3.1 Outline (to be written)	7
4 Progress Check	9
4.1 Outline (to be written)	9
5 Submission	11
5.1 Outline (to be written)	11
6 Common Errors and FAQ	13
6.1 Outline (to be written)	13

Preface

Welcome to the **BUSN 5000 Project Guide** — the canonical reference for the Pre-project, Project Progress Check, and Final Project for BUSN 5000 (Intro to Data Science for Business and Economics) at the University of Georgia.

This guide covers:

- How to set up your computer and your project folder
- What the pre-project is and how to complete it
- What the main project is and how to complete it
- What the progress check is and how it's graded
- How to submit your work
- How to recognize and recover from common errors

The guide is the single source of truth. Announcements on eLC remind you of upcoming deadlines and point back here for the rules.

How to use this guide

Read the chapters in order the first time through. After that, treat it as a reference — jump to whatever section you need. Each chapter has its own table of contents in the sidebar.

If you find a section that's wrong, unclear, or out of date, please flag it via the “report an issue” link at the top of any page.

Acknowledgments

The course materials in this guide are by **Chris Cornwell** and **Abbi Cormier**, with substantial contributions from the BUSN 5000 teaching team across many semesters.

1Setup

This chapter walks you through getting your computer ready to do BUSN 5000 project work.

1.1 Outline (to be written)

- Installing R and RStudio
- Installing the required R packages
- Understanding the project directory structure you'll create
- Where each file goes (the file-sort exercise)
- Running the setup-check script
- Opening the `.Rproj` file
- Verifying everything works

Note

This chapter is a stub. Content will be filled in as part of Wave 2 of the project rebuild. See `project_cleanup_findings.md` §10 in the working folder.

2Pre-project

This chapter covers the BUSN 5000 Pre-project Exercise.

2.1 Outline (to be written)

- Purpose of the pre-project
- What you'll produce (a 3-slide deck demonstrating setup)
- Step-by-step walkthrough
- Submission rubric (all-or-nothing 5 points; common formatting errors)
- Filename convention
- Common mistakes and how to avoid them

Note

This chapter is a stub. Content will be filled in as part of Wave 2 of the project rebuild.

3Main Project

This chapter is the slide-by-slide guide to the BUSN 5000 Project: **Exploring Pay Differences between Women and Men**.

3.1 Outline (to be written)

- Project overview and learning goals
- Data: March 2024 CPS ASEC
- The 35-slide deck structure
- Slide-by-slide instructions (migrated from the current Instructions HTML)
- Point allocations per slide
- Line limits and write-up rules

Note

This chapter is a stub. Content will be filled in as part of Wave 2 of the project rebuild.

4Progress Check

The Project Progress Check is an **optional bonus** opportunity that gives you feedback on your project halfway through and rewards progress.

4.1 Outline (to be written)

- What the progress check is and isn't
- Which slides are graded (Title, Academic Honesty, Distribution of earnings by gender, Wages and hours differences, Career log wage profiles, Evolution of the gender wage gap)
- Scoring: 5 points (clean), 3 points (formatting clean / content error), 0 (formatting error)
- How to submit
- How feedback is provided

Note

This chapter is a stub. Content will be filled in as part of Wave 2 of the project rebuild.

5Submission

This chapter covers how to submit your work to Gradescope without losing points to formatting.

5.1 Outline (to be written)

- Filename convention (`sectiontime_lastname_firstname_*.pdf`)
- PDF format (landscape, color, formatting preserved)
- The HTML → PDF workflow (not knit-to-PDF)
- Browser-specific save-as-PDF tips
- What “100% compliant with the knitted template” means in practice
- Deadlines and late-submission policy

Note

This chapter is a stub. Content will be filled in as part of Wave 2 of the project rebuild.

6Common Errors and FAQ

If something is broken, look here first.

6.1 Outline (to be written)

- The “did setup work?” diagnostic (`check_setup.R`)
- Common error catalog:
 - CSS in the wrong folder
 - `eval=FALSE` left on a completed chunk
 - YAML edited
 - Wrong working directory
 - Missing packages
 - Knit-to-PDF instead of HTML → PDF
 - Incorrect filename on Gradescope
- Communication policy (no content review by email; one thread per issue; no same-issue cross-emails)
- How to ask for help productively

Note

This chapter is a stub. Content will be filled in as part of Wave 2 of the project rebuild.

